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Title: Policy for the types and the indications for Central Venous Catheters in Paediatrics

This Policy aims at assisting the choice of the different types of central venous catheters in Children. It also describes the procedure for requesting for central venous catheters for pediatric patients.

What is A Central Venous Catheter?

- Central Venous Catheters (CVC) are different types of catheters that are inserted (percutaneously or surgically) into a central vein (e.g. SVC, IVC). They allow administration of intravenous therapies and blood sampling. The appropriate tip position for a central venous catheter is distal SVC or SVC/Right atrium (RA) junction using upper limb veins. These catheters are inserted under complete aseptic technique with continuous monitoring of vitals during the procedure.

Types of Central Venous Access (Catheters):

1. Short-term CVC (Temporary venous catheters)
2. Long-term CVC (PICC, Tunneled CVC, Indwelling venous Ports)

Temporary CVC:

These are catheters that are inserted in the neck or groin in the setting of acute indications to provide treatment for a brief duration (Replacement with a permanent device should occur within 5-10 days when possible if permanent access is needed).

Peripherally Inserted Central Catheter (PICC):

These are catheters that are inserted in a peripheral vein (usually basilic, brachial or cephalic veins) and terminate at superior vena cava (SVC) or the junction of SVC and right atrium. They are recommended when continuous venous access is required for a period from approximately 10 days until 6 months.

Tunneled CVC:

These are cuffed catheters that are inserted in a central vein and tunneled under the skin from a distance with its tip terminating at SVC or SVC/RA junction. They are used when a long-term continuous venous access is required, usually more than 6 months.

The insertion involves use of 2 incisions; one at the vein entrance site and the other at the catheter exit site (usually chest wall). A tunnel is made between those 2 sites where fibrous sheath forms around the catheter few weeks from insertion.

Neck veins including internal jugular and subclavian veins are used for long term catheters.

Subcutaneous Venous Port:

These are subcutaneously implanted venous access devices which consist of a catheter inserted in IJV and implanted port under the skin. These catheters are best used when intermittent chronic venous access is required. The Port is accessed as needed by trained staff for administration of drugs or blood products.

The choice of long term catheters is tailored according to:

- Age and weight of the child.
- Type of treatment required (daily or infrequent, one or multiple lumens).
- Duration of treatment.

Please consult Interventional Radiology team "IR" about the right choice for long term vascular access.

The available CVCs for use in children in the Royal hospital:

Temporary CVC:

- 4 Fr triple lumen
- 5 Fr double or triple-lumen and 5.5 triple lumen

PICC:

- 1.9 Fr single-lumen
- 2.6 Fr double-lumen
- 3 Fr single-lumen
- 4 Fr single or double-lumen

Tunneled CVC:

- 4.2 Fr single-lumen (Hickman's catheters-Bard)
- Other size/choices will be available soon.

Port A Catheters:

- 5 Fr single-lumen
- 5.5 Fr single-lumen

- 6.5Fr single-lumen

Suggestions for choice of CVCs based on treatment duration:

Temporary CVC: short treatment 5-10 days.

PICC: continuous daily treatment duration of 10 days - 6 months.

Tunneled CVC: continuous daily treatment > 6 months.

PortA Catheters: intermittent long-term treatment.

Indications for CVCs Insertion:

1. Blood products
2. Parenteral nutrition/lipids
3. Antibiotics
4. Dialysis/apheresis
5. Chemotherapy
6. Chelation therapy
7. Fluids/electrolytes
8. Systemic anticoagulation/thrombolysis
9. Delivery of caustic agents (e.g., Ca^{2+})
10. Other medications

Contra-indications for CVC Insertion:

1. Uncontrolled coagulopathy:
 - In children who requires these catheters emergently, their coagulopathy can be optimized with the use of FFP, cryoprecipitate and platelets (Discussion with IR team is required)
2. Bacteremia and septicemia:
 - It is recommended to treat underlying sepsis before insertion of long term tunneled catheters and ports for at least 48 hours.

Complications:

1. Bleeding.
2. Catheter infections. Rate of PICCsepsis=tunneled CVC in adults (1-3%).
3. Pneumothorax, hemothorax.
4. Injury to great vessels.
5. Venous thrombosis.
6. Catheter maintenance issues:
 - Occlusion, movement, fracture and leaking of catheters.
 - Fragmented catheters are retrieved from the heart and pulmonary vessels.
 - Signs include swelling, pain at the site and leakage around catheter.
7. Cardiac arrhythmias.

Clinical details required prior to insertions of CVC:

- Age and weight of the patient.
- Current medications.
- Purpose of the required CVC and duration of treatment.
- Previous CVC insertions.
- Anticoagulation medications “if present”.
- Status of CBC and coagulation profile.

Preparation for Percutaneous Insertions of CVCs:

- These procedures are usually done on Thursdays.
- Contact IR team to schedule the child for the procedure.
- The child needs to be reviewed by Anesthesia team.
- Stop anticoagulation medications, if any “e.g. heparin/aspirin” according to hospital protocol prior to surgery.
- Ensure the child has recent laboratory investigations:
- The child needs to remain fasting 6-8 hours prior to the procedure or as indicated by the anesthesia team.

Blood Investigations required prior to the procedure:

- CompleteBlood Count (CBC): hemoglobin and platelet count (Platelets >100 or >75 on “case-basis”).
- Coagulation profile:
- Activated Prothrombin Time (APTT <35 sec).
- International Normalized Ratio (INR< 1.2).
- Cross match (only major procedures).

Removal of the CVC:

If the catheter is not required any more or needs removal due to emergency reasons, removal is done with/without local anesthesia for PICC/ temporary CVC and under General Anesthesia for tunneled CVC or PortA catheters. Cuffed PICCs need to be removed by IR team.

References

Title of book/ journal/ articles/ Website	Author	Year of publication	Page
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2. Peripherally inserted central catheters.	Fabienne C. Bourgeois, Paula Lamagna	2011	
3. Central Venous access and related interventions. Pediatric Interventional Radiology, Springer	Temple, Michael. Marshall Leck, Francis E	2014	

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